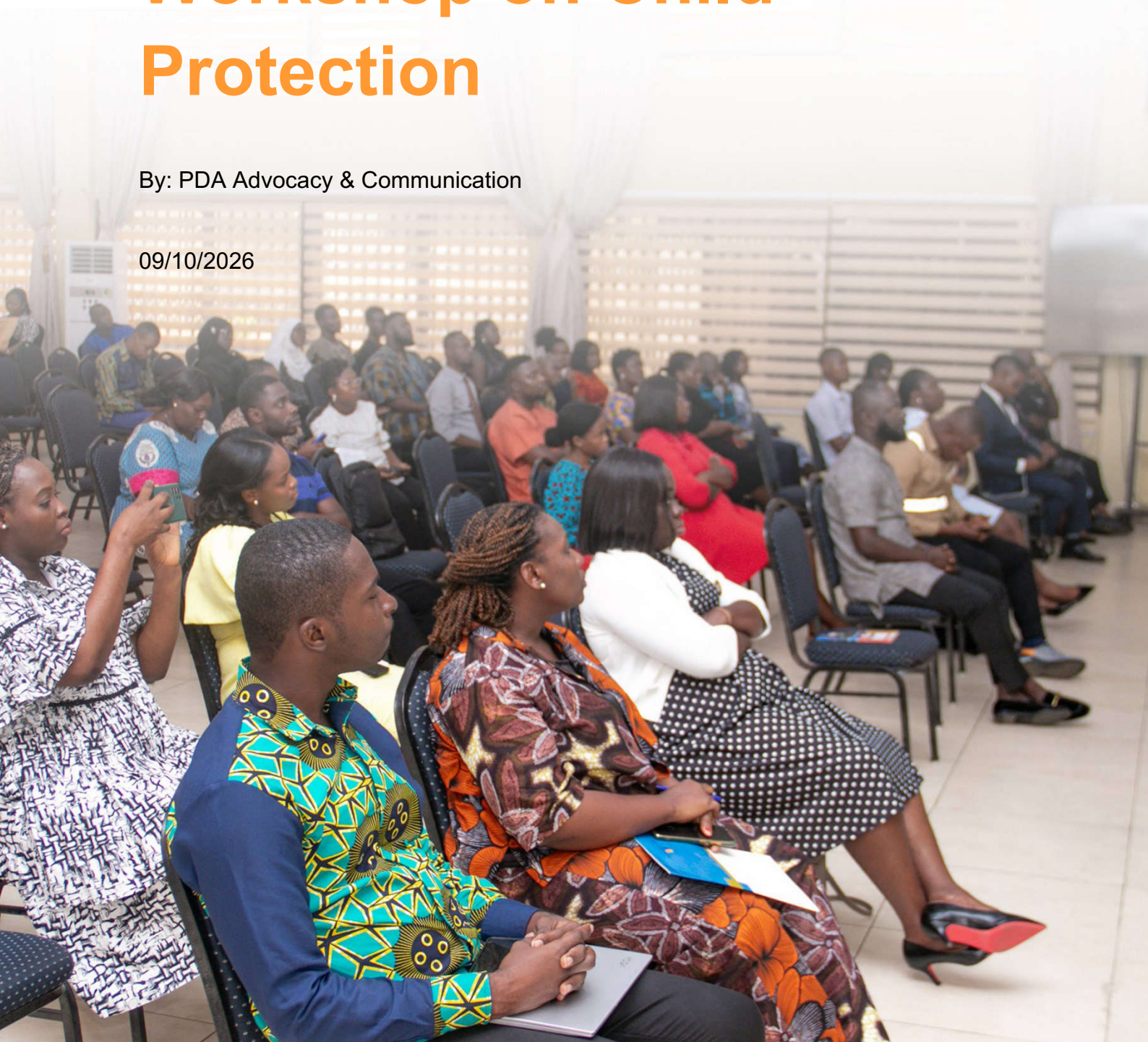
Concept Note

Participatory Development Associates Ltd.
... everyone matters

9th Knowledge Sharing Workshop on Child Protection

By: PDA Advocacy & Communication

09/10/2026



9TH KNOWLEDGE SHARING WORKSHOP ON CHILD PROTECTION – CONCEPT NOTE

THEME: **Digital Futures: Identity, Digital Safety and the Future of Child Protection in Ghana**

PDA Africa, in partnership with the Ministry of Gender, Children and Social Protection (MoGCSP) and the Ghana Internet Safety Foundation, invites you to the 9th PDA Knowledge Sharing Workshop on Child Protection on **3 December 2026** at the British Council, Accra.

BACKGROUND

PDA's annual Knowledge Sharing Workshops on Child Protection have brought government, civil society, development partners, communities and researchers together to share evidence and agree on practical steps to strengthen child protection in Ghana. This 9th workshop turns to two questions that are reshaping what it means to protect a child: who counts as a child in the eyes of the state, and how safe children are in the digital spaces where they now learn, play and connect.

Children in Ghana are growing up in a rapidly changing social, technological and economic environment. While many traditional threats to children's safety and wellbeing persist, new and emerging risks are fundamentally reshaping the child protection landscape.

Ghana is placing renewed emphasis on legal identity as part of its child development agenda, including efforts to strengthen birth registration and link civil registration with national identification systems. UNICEF has identified legal identity as one of Ghana's strategic priorities for children, alongside health, education, protection and social development.

At the same time, children's engagement with digital technologies is expanding rapidly. Artificial intelligence, social media, online learning platforms and other digital tools offer significant opportunities for education, communication and participation but also introduce emerging risks relating to privacy, exploitation, harmful content, manipulation, cyberbullying and digital wellbeing. Ghana's Cyber Security Authority has consequently strengthened its Child Online Protection work and continues to promote safer digital environments for children.

WHY THIS TOPIC? WHY NOW?

Childhood is changing: AI and digital technology are transforming children's experience of growing up, offering real opportunities for learning and participation while exposing children to new risks.

Identity is becoming digital: A child's legal identity, beginning with birth registration, is the gateway to rights and services. Digital technology is now creating new forms of identity that also need to be recognized and safeguarded.

Risks are moving faster than laws and systems: Parents, schools and institutions are asking how to protect children online, and whether Ghana's child protection system is keeping pace with how children now live, learn and interact.

The workshop follows a child's journey from birth and registration to legal identity, to access to rights and services, to digital participation, digital identity and digital safety. It asks where children are protected along the way, and where they are being left behind.

A child's journey to digital protection



OBJECTIVES

To convene key stakeholders to examine emerging dimensions of child protection in Ghana, generate evidence-informed dialogue, strengthen collaboration and identify practical actions for ensuring that children are *recognized, protected and able to safely participate in society and the digital environment*.

The workshop will seek to:

1. Examine the state of birth registration and legal identity in Ghana, including barriers to timely registration and the role of legal identity as an entry point to healthcare, education, social protection, justice and other rights.
2. Explore the opportunities and risks that AI, social media and digital technologies bring to children's lives, including online exploitation, cyberbullying, privacy and digital wellbeing, and the growing link between legal and digital identity.
3. Generate evidence-informed dialogue among policymakers, practitioners, communities, technology actors, development partners and children, and agree on practical steps to strengthen child protection at national and community levels.
4. Strengthen collaboration across government, civil society, communities and the private sector to sustain advocacy, research, programming and systemic change.

FORMAT AND KEY SESSIONS

The workshop is an in-person, one-day event combining presentations, a short documentary, facilitated roundtable group work, a panel discussion and exhibition stands showcasing the work of participating organizations. It is built around two thematic sessions:

- **Session 1: Birth registration, legal identity and the right to belong.** Birth registration as a child right, barriers to timely registration, the link between health facilities and registration, access to rights and services, and the future of identity.
- **Session 2: AI, online safety and emerging cyber risks for children.** Children and AI, online safety and exploitation, children's data and privacy, digital wellbeing, the role of parents, schools and institutions, and who is being left behind.

The workshop will look at how these issues affect children differently: rural and urban children, children with disabilities, children from vulnerable households, children without legal identity, children outside formal education, children in hard-to-reach communities, and children with limited digital access or with access but inadequate protection.

The program for the day is planned as follows:

Time	Activity
9:30 – 10:00	Registration and networking
10:00 – 10:15	Opening, welcome and framing of the workshop
10:15 – 11:15	**Presentations**: *1*: The State of Child Identity in Ghana *2*: AI, Online Safety and Emerging Cyber Risks for Children *3:* Digital Safety from Policy to Practice
11:15 – 11:30	Video documentary
11:30 – 11:45	*Group photograph, break and exhibitions*
11:45 – 12:05	**Presentation**: Protecting Children in Ghana's Digital World
12:05 – 1:10	Roundtable group work, group presentations and interactive session
1:10 – 1:50	*Lunch, break and exhibitions*
1:50 – 2:05	A Word from the Children – GISF CyberSafe Ambassadors
2:05 – 2:30	**Panel**: Protecting Ghanaian Children's Identity, Rights and Safety in the Digital Age
2:30 – 3:00	Audience interactive session
3:00 – 3:15	Synthesis and key action points
3:15 – 3:30	*Closing and group photograph*

WHO SHOULD ATTEND?

The workshop will bring together people who shape, deliver and experience child protection and digital safety:

Government:

- Ministry of Gender, Children and Social Protection
- Births and Deaths Registry
- National Identification Authority
- Ghana Health Service
- Ghana Education Service
- Ministry of Communications, Digital Technology and Innovations
- Cyber Security Authority
- NITA
- Data Protection Commission
- National Development Planning Commission
- CHRAJ
- DOVVSU and the Ghana Police Service
- District Assemblies

Development partners and civil society:

- UNICEF Ghana
- WHO
- UNDP
- World Bank
- Child Online Africa
- ICI, SOS and Plan Ghana
- Safe Schools Programme
- Non-Profit Organization Secretariat

Private sector and technology:

- Telecommunications companies
- Technology and EdTech organizations
- AI, cybersecurity and digital identity experts

Communities and frontline practitioners:

- Traditional leaders
- Parents and caregivers
- Teachers
- Health workers
- Community volunteers
- Social welfare and juvenile justice officers
- Birth registration officers
- Students and pupils

EXPECTED OUTCOMES

The workshop will produce:

- **Shared understanding** of the links between legal identity, digital identity, online safety and AI in child protection.
- **Clearer protection pathways:** a practical picture of child protection touchpoints, referral pathways and system gaps, from birth registration to digital safety.
- **Practical guidance** for organizations, religious institutions, schools and caregivers on protecting children and using AI safely and responsibly.
- **Priority actions for systems change** to close the policy-to-practice gap, particularly for rural and underserved children.
- **Stronger collaboration** among government, civil society, communities, and education and technology actors.

EVENT DETAILS

Date	**Thursday, 3 December 2026**
Time	Registration from 9:30 AM; programme from 10:00 AM – 3:30 PM
Venue	British Council, Accra
Organizers	PDA Africa in partnership with the Ministry of Gender, Children and Social Protection and the Ghana Internet Safety Foundation
Format	In-person (register here for participation)

APPENDIX: THEMATIC SESSION BREAKDOWNS

Through presentations, plenary discussions and small-group work, participants will share experiences and knowledge on the key areas under each session to ensure that national conversations translate into community-level realities and behavioural change. We encourage all participants to reflect on these issues as they prepare to join us for the event.

SESSION 1 - EVERY CHILD COUNTS

Birth Registration, Legal Identity and the Right to Belong

This session will examine birth registration as more than an administrative process. It will explore legal identity as a foundational child right and an entry point to protection and access to services.

Birth registration as a child right

- Why every child should be registered from birth
- Registration within the first year
- Children born outside health facilities
- Children in vulnerable and hard-to-reach communities

Access to rights and services

- Education
- Healthcare
- Social protection
- National identification
- Justice and protection services

The health facility–registration connection

- Birth notification
- Health facilities as points of registration
- Ghana Health Service and Births and Deaths Registry collaboration
- Strengthening referral and registration pathways

Who is being left behind?

- Rural communities
- Poor and vulnerable households
- Children with disabilities
- Children born outside formal systems
- Children whose parents lack documentation

The future of identity

- Birth registration and national identification
- Digital identity
- Interoperability between systems
- Children's data protection and privacy

SESSION 2 - GROWING UP DIGITAL

AI, Online Safety and Emerging Cyber Risks for Children

This session will examine how technological change is transforming childhood and what this means for child protection. Ghana's child online-protection work already recognises risks associated with online interaction, harmful content, exploitation and children's digital behaviour. The emergence and rapid adoption of AI introduce additional questions around children's privacy, wellbeing, learning and exposure to manipulated or harmful content.

Children and Artificial Intelligence

- How children are using AI
- AI in education
- AI literacy
- Misinformation and manipulated content
- Deepfakes and emerging risks
- Responsible and child-centred AI

Online safety and exploitation

- Online grooming
- Cyberbullying
- Harmful content
- Online exploitation
- Fake identities and manipulation
- Reporting and referral mechanisms

Children's data and privacy

- Children's digital footprints
- Personal information
- School and health data
- Data collected by digital platforms
- Privacy and consent

Digital wellbeing

- Social media
- Algorithms and addictions
- Excessive engagement
- Digital relationships
- Mental and social wellbeing

Parents, schools and institutions

- Digital parenting
- Teacher preparedness
- School policies
- Digital literacy
- Child-friendly reporting mechanisms

Participatory Development Associates Ltd.
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We collaborate locally and globally with communities, state and non-state actors to generate knowledge, evidence and insights that reflect the voices of individuals, communities, and institutions to advance an equitable and sustainable world.

Scan the QR code to visit our website

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